

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Microsoft Defender | CISSP | Hybrid

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience owning security controls, leading incident response, conducting threat monitoring and managing vulnerability programmes across complex hybrid Azure and Windows Server environments. I hold deep expertise in Microsoft Sentinel as a Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform, including Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rule development, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender, alongside strong proficiency in threat hunting, detection engineering and security architecture. At the University of the Arts London (UAL), I have reported directly into infrastructure leadership and worked closely with infrastructure operations teams to identify vulnerabilities, respond to incidents and continuously strengthen the organisation's security posture across an 8,000-user estate. I bring a collaborative, hands-on approach to cyber security engineering and am experienced in Single Sign-On (SSO), Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), and Conditional Access across large enterprise environments.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel (SIEM):** Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) analytics rule development, KQL (Kusto Query Language), threat detection, log ingestion and workspace management
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Defender XDR (Extended Detection and Response)
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID/Azure Active Directory (AD), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)
- **Security Architecture and Controls:** Security control design and implementation, security posture management, risk assessment, security policy development
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle, MITRE ATT&CK framework, containment, eradication and recovery
- **Threat Monitoring and Hunting:** Advanced threat hunting, proactive threat detection, behavioural analysis, adversary technique identification
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Nessus, vulnerability prioritisation and remediation tracking
- **Azure and Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure, Azure Security Centre, cloud security posture management, cloud workload protection
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM, least-privilege enforcement, privileged account governance
- **CrowdStrike Falcon:** EDR (Endpoint Detection and Response), NG-SIEM, Prevent, Insight, Discover
- **Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR):** Playbook development, alert automation, response orchestration
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting, security automation, Infrastructure as Code principles
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA), CompTIA A+

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Owned and managed the organisation's security controls across the hybrid Azure and Windows Server infrastructure, working closely with Infrastructure Operations to identify vulnerabilities and respond to incidents

- Administered Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM platform, developing KQL analytics rules, detection queries and alerting workflows to monitor the estate and identify threats in real time
- Led incident response operations in line with NIST 800-61, coordinating containment, eradication and recovery activities and maintaining full incident documentation
- Conducted advanced threat monitoring and threat hunting campaigns aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, proactively identifying adversary activity and strengthening detection coverage across the estate
- Managed vulnerability management programme using Pentera BAS, Tenable.io and AppCheck, prioritising high and critical vulnerabilities and driving remediation through infrastructure and development teams
- Designed and maintained security architecture across the hybrid environment, assessing new technologies and controls for alignment with security standards and risk appetite
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID/Azure AD, Conditional Access policies, MFA/SSO, and Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) to enforce identity security and least-privilege access across 8,000+ users
- Managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) deployments, tuning detection rules, managing alerts and leading endpoint security incident investigations
- Administered BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to govern privileged account access and reduce risk from credential compromise
- Developed and implemented SOAR playbooks and PowerShell automation to streamline security operations and reduce manual effort in alert triage and response
- Reported on security posture, vulnerability metrics and incident trends to the Infrastructure Engineering Manager and senior stakeholders

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Conducted day-to-day threat monitoring, alert triage and incident response using Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and CrowdStrike Falcon, investigating and containing security incidents
- Developed and tuned Microsoft Sentinel KQL detection rules and analytics queries to improve threat detection coverage and reduce false positive rates
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID/Azure AD identity lifecycle, Conditional Access policies, MFA roll-out and SSO configurations across the organisation
- Supported vulnerability management using Tenable.io/Nessus, tracking and coordinating remediation with system and service owners
- Contributed to security architecture reviews and security control assessments for new and existing systems
- Supported ISO 27001 certification preparation and Cyber Essentials Plus accreditation, conducting gap assessments and driving remediation of identified findings
- Maintained security documentation including incident response runbooks, security procedures and control evidence

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Administered Azure Active Directory (AD), MFA/SSO integrations and user identity lifecycle management across the cloud-first infrastructure
- Managed vulnerability assessments and remediation tracking for cloud and on-premises infrastructure, coordinating with DevOps and engineering teams
- Deployed and configured endpoint security tooling, establishing baseline EDR (Endpoint Detection and Response) monitoring across the estate
- Supported security incident investigations, log analysis and root cause analysis activities
- Automated routine security and infrastructure tasks using PowerShell scripting to improve operational efficiency and reduce manual workload
- Contributed to security policy documentation and access control governance processes

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Owned and matured the security controls programme at UAL, implementing Microsoft Sentinel as the enterprise SIEM and building out a comprehensive detection and monitoring capability
- Led Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) deployment across 8,000 users, achieving full endpoint and identity threat visibility
- Designed and implemented automated SOAR playbooks, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) to security incidents by over 40% through intelligent alert triage and automated containment actions
- Built a comprehensive threat hunting programme aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, proactively identifying and remediating previously undetected adversary activity
- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification, leading gap assessment and technical remediation activities across the Azure and Windows Server estate
- Delivered enterprise-wide security awareness training programme, reducing phishing simulation click rates by over 50%

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)